

Participant information sheet

Communicating Validation Outcomes

Version 1, 14th April 2025

Research ethics approval number:

Name of researcher(s): Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska (Principal Investigator), Dr Hannah Little (Co-Investigator)

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and feel free to ask us if you would like more information or if there is anything that you do not understand. We would like to stress that you do not have to accept this invitation and should only agree to take part if you want to.

Background

Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska and Dr Hannah Little have been working on recommendations on how to communicate about the outcomes of validation processes. To achieve this, they are working to establish how engineers are currently communicating about the outcomes from model validation, specifically with non-specialist audiences.

We are inviting you to take part in a short survey which asks how you would communicate the outcomes of two validation case studies. **Participation is entirely voluntary, and you are free to withdraw your participation at any time without explanation, and without incurring a disadvantage.**

If you are willing to take part in this research, your participation will only require an **online survey which should not take more than 5 or 10 minutes**. The survey will ask you to read some results from validation processes and then ask you to describe the results as you would for a non-specialist industry audience.

Responses will be anonymous and the results will be analysed for academic publications (e.g. journal papers or academic book chapters) and will be used to inform further work that assesses how people interpret and understand the language used by engineers. This body of work will eventually inform recommendations for engineers on how to communicate about the outcomes from validation processes.

As part of this study, you may optionally give your contact information to be informed about the results and any resulting publications, reports or recommendations. The University processes personal data as part of its research and teaching activities in accordance with the lawful basis of 'public task', and in accordance with the University's purpose of advancing education, learning and research for the public benefit.

Under UK data protection legislation, the University acts as the Data Controller for personal data collected as part of the University's research. Dr. Hannah Little acts as the Data Processor for this study, and any queries relating to the handling of your personal data can be sent to Hannah.Little@liverpool.ac.uk.

Your data will be anonymized and any identifying information (including your email and information you may give yourself as part of an answer) will be removed from the survey results. You will be given

a participant number which corresponds to your recorded responses which you can use in the event of communicating about your data. Your email address, if provided, will be stored separately.

Further information on how your data will be used can be found in the table below.

How will my data be collected?	We will use Microsoft forms to collect responses from an online survey.
How will my data be stored?	Survey responses will be stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool. Only Dr Hannah Little and Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska will have access to this server. Fully anonymized data will be published as part of an open-source dataset on the Open Science Foundation site.
How long will my data be stored for?	Private repositories of the data will be stored until the completion of the project and any resulting publications and reports have been published. Open-source data will remain available after this.
What measures are in place to protect the security and confidentiality of my data?	All data will be stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool which is only accessible by the research team (the principal investigator and co-investigator). Only fully anonymized data will be published as part of an open-source dataset on the Open Science Foundation site
Will my data be anonymised?	Yes, you will be given a participant number which corresponds to your survey responses which you can use in the event of communicating about your data (e.g. if you wish to request its destruction). Any information which may identify you, such as your email address, will be stored separately and will never be published.
How will my data be used?	Your responses will be analysed to identify how language is used to communicate about the outcomes of validation processes. This analysis will be published, for example as part of journal papers or academic book chapters.
Who will have access to my data?	Only the principal investigator and co-investigator will have access to your submitted data. Anonymized open-source data will be open to anyone.
Will my data be archived for use in other research projects in the future?	Yes, as part of an open-source dataset.
How will my data be destroyed?	Personal data (e.g. email addresses) will be deleted once the project has concluded and resulting reports have been published.

Will I be remunerated for my time?

Survey participants will not be remunerated.

Are there any benefits in taking part?

Your data will be used to produce recommendations for engineers for how to communicate with non-specialize audiences. If you choose, you will be sent these recommendations when they are available.

Are there any risks in taking part?

There are no known risks in relation to participating in these surveys. You may refuse to answer any question at any time. If any participant experiences discomfort or disadvantage as part of the research, they should make the principal investigator (Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska) aware immediately.

What will happen to the results of the study?

The results will contribute to further survey work which will look at how those in industry and the wider public interpret the use of language by engineers. The results of these surveys collectively will inform recommendations for engineering communication, and form the basis of journal publications and book chapters.

What will happen if I want to stop taking part?

You can withdraw your participation in the study at any time without explanation, both during the survey and after data collection. After 2 months, your data will have been used to inform future survey work and maybe be included in published analyses, but you may still request we delete your records from both private and open-source datasets.

If you withdraw part-way through a survey, responses recorded before your withdrawal will be deleted. Otherwise, you may request that the recording is destroyed, and no further use is made of them. While responses will be anonymised, you will be given a participant number which you can use to request your responses are destroyed. As such, you should keep a record of your participant number and use this in correspondence with the principal investigator (Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska), should you wish to communicate about or to withdraw your participation.

What if I am unhappy or if there is a problem?

If you are unhappy, or if there is a problem, please feel free to let us know by contacting Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska (K.Dvurecenska@liverpool.ac.uk) and we will try to help. If you remain unhappy or have a complaint which you feel you cannot come to us with then you should contact the Research Ethics and Integrity Office at ethics@liv.ac.uk. When contacting the Research Ethics and Integrity Office, please provide details of the name or description of the study (so that it can be identified), the researcher(s) involved, and the details of the complaint you wish to make.

The University strives to maintain the highest standards of rigour in the processing of your data. However, if you have any concerns about the way in which the University processes your personal data, it is important that you are aware of your right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office by calling 0303 123 1113.

Who can I contact if I have further questions?

Any queries should be directed to the principal investigator or co-investigator:

Dr Ksenija Dvurecenska

K.Dvurecenska@liverpool.ac.uk

0151 794 4821

University of Liverpool
School of Engineering
Faculty of Science and Engineering
The Quadrangle, Brownlow Hill
Liverpool L69 3GH

Dr Hannah Little

Hannah.little@liverpool.ac.uk

0151 7953848

University of Liverpool
School of the Arts
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences
19 Abercromby Square (Office 328)
Liverpool L69 7ZG